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Functions in PHP and MySQL worth knowing!

Just started learning PHP or MySQL? Well, here's a consolidated list of some of the important functions in PHP and MySQL which are quite handy:



Pranet Sab

Remember how effortless it was to write your first "Hello World!" program in PHP? Now, it's time to move on to the next level where you can actually build something using MySQL and PHP. Despite how powerful these languages are, they're quite easy to learn and can help turn you into the next web tycoon. So if you're a beginner, then use this article to learn some basic useful

functions and if you're an expert, then use this as a cheat sheet. So, let's get started, shall we?

1. Connect to the database

This function is like the "Hello World" program of MySQL and is the most important one if you want to perform any task related to the MySQL database. The code is also pretty simple:

```
<?php
$servername = "localhost";
$username = "root";
$password = "password";
$dbname = "database name";

// Create connection
$conn = new mysqli($servername, $username, $password, $dbname);
// Check connection
if ($conn->connect_error) {
    die("Connection failed: " . $conn->connect_error);
}
?>
```

Here, you'll just need to change the servername, username, password and databasename. You can obtain all these details from your cPanel or from 'phpMyAdmin'. Basically, this code will make a connection to the MySQL database, only after which you can execute any database query. Users generally confuse the username with the database name, so make sure you aren't making this mistake. Another good practice is to put this "connection" in a separate .php file and then use 'include("connection.php");' function of PHP to call it on relevant pages. This is extremely useful if you ever need to change details related to your database, since changes then need to be made in just one file instead of in every file.

2. Fetch data from the database

Now imagine you have a database that has all the records of something important. This would be useless if you can't fetch data from it. And that's why fetching data is another basic function without which your large database would be pointless. The following code will fetch data from DB and then "echo" it to the user.

```
<?php
include("connection.php"); //this file contains the connection details as
shown in previous point

$sql = "SELECT * FROM table name"; //change the table name appropriately
$result = $conn->query($sql); //the $conn variable is defined in
connection.php file

while($row = $result->fetch_assoc()) { //it simply fetched the cell data,
nothing more fancy here
    echo "<table><tr><td>".$row["column name"]."</td></tr></table>"; //and lastly we can use echo or any other
function as per our need
}

mysqli_close($conn);
?>
```

Check the first line of the code that has the 'include' function. This function enables connection to the database. In the same folder, there should be a file named "connection.php" that we created earlier. It will have the code as described in the "Connect to the database" point.

3. Update and apply maths to your data

Yet another extremely handy function that lets you update your data and make calculations. Let's look at a situation in which it

```
<?php
include("connection.php"); //connect to DB

$id = mysqli_real_escape_string($conn, $_GET["id"]); //get the id that user
entered in your HTML form

$row = mysqli_fetch_object(mysqli_query($conn, "SELECT * FROM table name
WHERE id=".$id)); //we are using WHERE to identify the row corresponding to
the provided id

$updated_points = $row->points+10; //it gets the current value of points
and then adds 10 to it

if(mysqli_query($conn, "UPDATE table name SET points=".$updated_points." WHERE
id=".$id.")); //this query is used to update the points and WHERE is again
used to identify the correct row.

mysqli_close($conn); //close the connection if you don't need it anymore.
?>
```